

RELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE: NATURE AND OBJECT

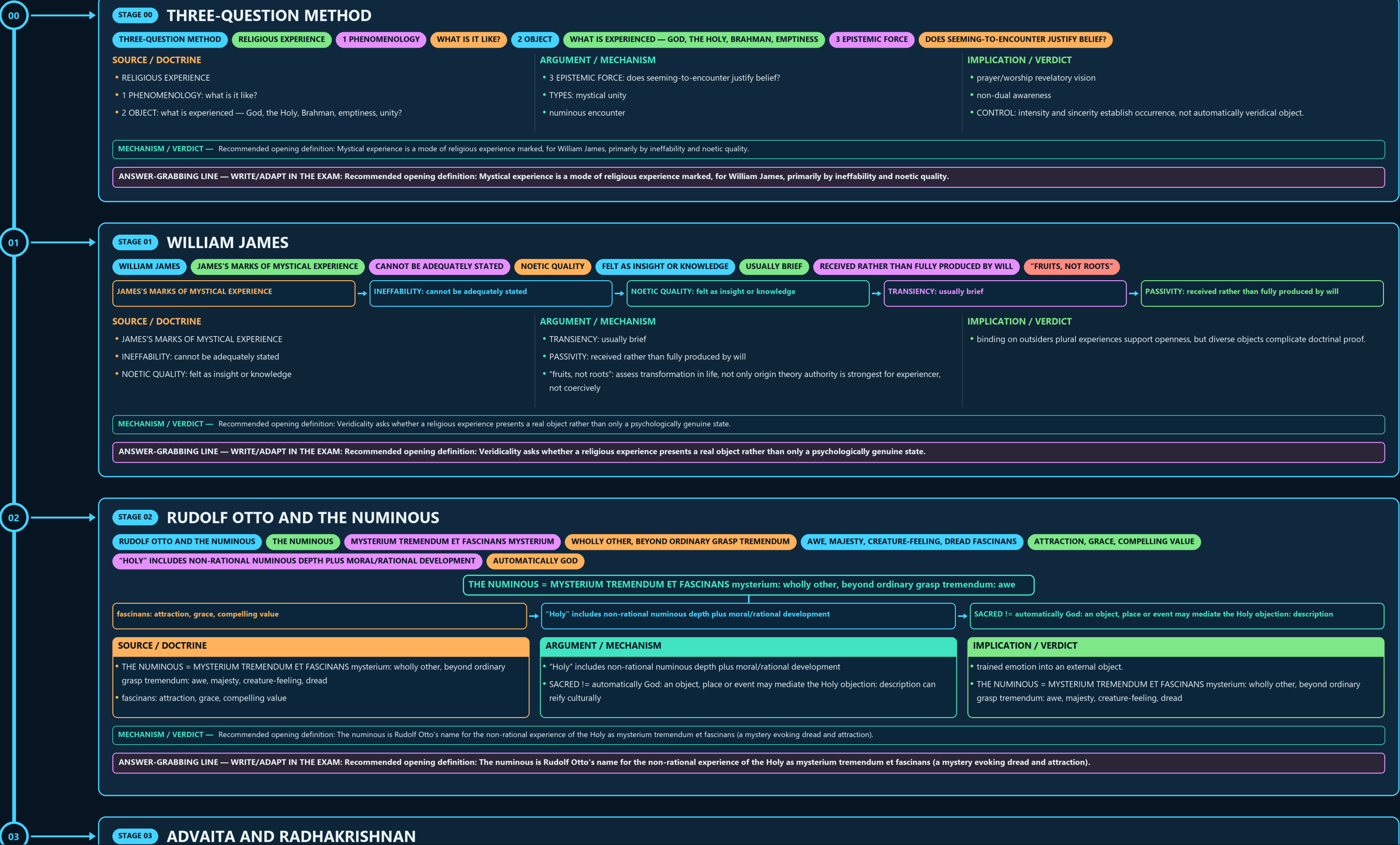
THREE-QUESTION METHOD → WILLIAM JAMES → RUDOLF OTTO AND THE → ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNAN → OBJECT MODELS → VERIDICALITY TESTS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g9 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: The numinous is Rudolf Otto's name for the non-rational experience of the Holy as mysterium tremendum et fascinans (a mystery evoking dread and attraction).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: The numinous is Rudolf Otto's name for the non-rational experience of the Holy as mysterium tremendum et fascinans (a mystery evoking dread and attraction).

03

STAGE 03ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNAN

ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNAN

APAROKṢĀNUBHŪTI IS IMMEDIATE KNOWLEDGE OF NON-DUAL BRAHMAN NOT SUBJECT

LIBERATING KNOWLEDGE

INTEGRAL INTUITION DISCLOSES SPIRITUAL UNITY AND GROUNDS TOLERANCE STRENGTH

EXPERIENCE IS TRANSFORMATIVE AND NON-INFERENTIAL PRESSURE

INEFFABILITY VS DOCTRINAL DESCRIPTION; PRIVATE CERTAINTY VS PUBLIC ADJUDICATION

ADVAITA INTERPRETATION MAY BE ONE CONCEPTUAL CONSTRUCTION AMONG RELIGIOUS

ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object

subject-object division is sublated śravaṇa → manana → nididhyāsana → liberating knowledge

RADHAKRISHNAN: integral intuition discloses spiritual unity and grounds tolerance strength: experience is transformative and non-inferential

private certainty vs public adjudication

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object
- subject-object division is sublated śravaṇa → manana → nididhyāsana → liberating knowledge

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RADHAKRISHNAN: integral intuition discloses spiritual unity and grounds tolerance strength: experience is transformative and non-inferential pressure: ineffability vs
- private certainty vs public adjudication

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- Advaita interpretation may be one conceptual construction among religious traditions.
- ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Religious experience is an experience interpreted as disclosing or relating the subject to an ultimate, sacred or divine reality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Religious experience is an experience interpreted as disclosing or relating the subject to an ultimate, sacred or divine reality.

04

STAGE 04OBJECT MODELS

OBJECT MODELS

MODEL WHAT EXPERIENCE PRESENTS PERSONAL THEISM AN ADDRESSIVE "THOU,"

OTTO NUMINOUS HOLY

WHOLLY OTHER

ADVAITA NON-DUAL BRAHMAN; NO FINAL SUBJECT-OBJECT SPLIT

BUDDHISM EMPTINESS, CESSATION OR SUCHNESS WITHOUT CREATOR NATURALISM ALTERED

SAME PHENOMENOLOGICAL REPORT MAY UNDERDETERMINE ONTOLOGY

OBJECT-CLAIM NEEDS INTERPRETATION BEYOND RAW IMMEDIACY.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
MODEL WHAT EXPERIENCE PRESENTS personal theism an addressive "Thou," grace, command, presence	Advaita non-dual Brahman; no final subject-object split	SAME phenomenological report may underdetermine ontology
Otto numinous Holy / wholly other	Buddhism emptiness, cessation or suchness without creator naturalism altered brain/body state interpreted religiously	object-claim needs interpretation beyond raw immediacy.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- MODEL WHAT EXPERIENCE PRESENTS personal theism an addressive "Thou," grace, command, presence
- Otto numinous Holy / wholly other

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Advaita non-dual Brahman; no final subject-object split
- Buddhism emptiness, cessation or suchness without creator naturalism altered brain/body state interpreted religiously

EVALUATION / TRAP

- SAME phenomenological report may underdetermine ontology
- object-claim needs interpretation beyond raw immediacy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: The sacred is the generic category of reality set apart as ultimately significant, while the Holy names the numinous value and presence emphasised by Otto.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: The sacred is the generic category of reality set apart as ultimately significant, while the Holy names the numinous value and presence emphasised by Otto.

05

STAGE 05VERIDICALITY TESTS

VERIDICALITY TESTS

SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY

ACCEPT SEEMING APPEARANCE UNLESS DEFEATED

PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY

GENERALLY TRUST REPORTS UNLESS THERE IS REASON NOT TO

PRIOR IMPLAUSIBILITY

UNRELIABLE SETTING POSITIVE CHECKS

MORAL FRUIT

SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated

PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to

DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology

prior implausibility

unreliable setting positive checks: coherence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated
- PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to
- DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology
- prior implausibility

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- unreliable setting positive checks: coherence
- moral fruit
- intersubjective fit
- predictive/explanatory value

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ALSTON: socially established doxastic practice may confer prima facie justification objection: incompatible religious practices cannot all validate exclusive
- objects unchanged.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Alston's perceptual model treats mystical perception as an experience in which God appears to be directly presented.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Alston's perceptual model treats mystical perception as an experience in which God appears to be directly presented.

RELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE: NATURE AND OBJECT • TILE 2/3 • same master rows 2823-6057 of 8880 • continues below

- PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to
- DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology
- prior implausibility

- moral fruit
- intersubjective fit
- predictive/explanatory value

- objects unchanged.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Alston's perceptual model treats mystical perception as an experience in which God appears to be directly presented.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Alston's perceptual model treats mystical perception as an experience in which God appears to be directly presented.

06

STAGE 06CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND PUBLIC LIFE

CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND PUBLIC LIFE

SOCIAL CONSOLATION

NEURAL CORRELATE PLURALISM

CONTRADICTORY INTERPRETATIONS

NO COMMUNICABLE EVIDENCE REPLIES

CAUSAL EXPLANATION DOES NOT EQUAL DEBUNKING; ALL PERCEPTION HAS

FRUITS AND DISCIPLINED PRACTICES MAY DISTINGUISH MATURE EXPERIENCE FROM

PETITION, GRATITUDE, SURRENDER, CONTEMPLATION PUBLIC USE MUST BE MODEST

FREUD: wish-fulfilment

MARX: social consolation

neuroscience: neural correlate pluralism: contradictory interpretations

ineffability: no communicable evidence replies: causal explanation does not equal debunking; all perception has neural

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

FREUD: wish-fulfilment

MARX: social consolation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

neuroscience: neural correlate pluralism: contradictory interpretations

ineffability: no communicable evidence replies: causal explanation does not equal debunking; all perception has neural correlates

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

fruits and disciplined practices may distinguish mature experience from fantasy prayer/worship test

object-relations: petition, gratitude, surrender, contemplation public

use must be modest: experience may justify commitment without authorising coercion.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Prayer is communicative address to the ultimate, whereas worship is the acknowledgement and enactment of supreme worth.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Prayer is communicative address to the ultimate, whereas worship is the acknowledgement and enactment of supreme worth.

07

STAGE 07PYQ ANSWER SPINE

PYQ ANSWER SPINE

DEFINE TYPE

DESCRIBE PHENOMENOLOGY WITH JAMES/OTTO

SPECIFY CLAIMED OBJECT

DISTINGUISH EXPERIENCE FROM INTERPRETATION

APPLY CREDULITY/TESTIMONY AND DEFEATERS

COMPARE ADVAITA/THEISM/BUDDHISM

STRONGEST NATURALIST OR PLURALIST OBJECTION

DEFINE type → describe phenomenology with James/Otto → specify claimed object

distinguish experience from interpretation → apply credulity/testimony and defeaters

compare Advaita/theism/Buddhism → strongest naturalist or pluralist objection

reply → qualified public verdict

CLOSE: religious experience is significant evidence within a life and practice, but its object is

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

DEFINE type → describe phenomenology with James/Otto → specify claimed object

distinguish experience from interpretation → apply credulity/testimony and defeaters

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

compare Advaita/theism/Buddhism → strongest naturalist or pluralist objection

reply → qualified public verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

CLOSE: religious experience is significant evidence within a life and practice, but its object is not read straight off the feeling

interpretation and defeater control remain.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Public discourse requires private religious experience to be translated into claims assessable through shared reasons and observable consequences.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Public discourse requires private religious experience to be translated into claims assessable through shared reasons and observable consequences.

E

EXTRASUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

DOCTRINE STATEMENT.

MYSTICAL STATES ARE MARKED BY INEFFABILITY AND NOETIC QUALITY

THEIR AUTHORITY IS STRONGEST FOR THE SUBJECT AND TESTED

JAMES GATHERS FIRST-PERSON REPORTS, IDENTIFIES RECURRENT PHENOMENOLOGICAL FEATURES, AND

PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

FIRST-PERSON TESTIMONY IS LEGITIMATE DATA AND PRAGMATIC TRANSFORMATION IS

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

Doctrine statement.

Mystical states are marked by ineffability and noetic quality, with transiency and passivity as usual additional marks

their authority is strongest for the subject and tested pragmatically by fruits.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

Argument.

James gathers first-person reports, identifies recurrent phenomenological features, and refuses to reduce their value to pathological origins because

Presupposition. CAUTION: First-person testimony is legitimate data and pragmatic transformation is evidentially relevant.

Distinction. Noetic quality means experienced insight, not independently demonstrated knowledge.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

Canonical example. Conversion reorganises a divided self and is assessed through enduring moral integration.

Objection → reply.

CAUTION: Private certainty cannot establish a public object.

James restricts coercive authority: the experience may rationally authorise the experiencer without binding outsiders.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.